

Katana Agent — Install & User Guide

Android capture app for UPI payments · download <https://katanapay.co/katana-agent.apk> · v3.08

What this app is for: money paid into your payment app (Paytm, Airtel, Google Pay, PhonePe, BharatPe) reaches your Katana dashboard on its own — but the **RRN / UTR**, the 12-digit reference that proves *which* payment it was, is only ever shown **on the payment app's own screen**. The Katana Agent runs on the phone, reads that reference off the screen, and sends it to your dashboard. No typing.

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1. What you need

- An **Android phone, version 11 or newer**. Use a **dedicated phone** that stays on and on charge — this is the single biggest factor in how much gets captured.
- Your **payment app** installed and **logged in** to the business account that receives the money.
- Your **merchant code** (e.g. `MTCI-01`) — ask your Katana admin. Captures are stamped with this code, so it decides which account the money is credited to.

2. Install the app

1. On the phone, open <https://katanapay.co/katana-agent.apk> in the browser and download it.

2. Open the downloaded file → allow **"Install unknown apps"** if prompted → **Install**.
3. Android will show a **Play Protect** warning. Tap **More details** → **Install anyway** (or **Install without scanning**).

The Play Protect warning is expected. It appears for any sideloaded app that reads SMS, which this one does so bank credit alerts are forwarded. It is not a sign that anything is wrong.

Updates install over the top — same signing key, so there is no need to uninstall first, and your settings survive. But see the warning in §3 about what an update does to the screen reader.

3. First-time setup (~5 minutes)

Open **Katana Agent** and work down the screen.

Step 1 — CONNECTION (do this first)

Scroll to **CONNECTION**, enter your **merchant code**, leave **Forward alerts** on, and tap **Save settings**. The line must read **✓ verified**.

What it says	What it means
✓ verified	The server recognised the code. This is the only state that captures.
✗ not recognized	The server does not know this code. Re-check it — a typo sends money to the wrong account, or to nobody.
⚠ can't reach server	The code may be fine; the phone has no working internet. Check the connection.
(save to verify)	Not checked yet. Tap Save settings .

Check the code character by character. A code with a stray space (GUFFI-01 hu) once sat saved for hours looking healthy. The app now refuses to claim it is capturing until the server has confirmed the code — but only you can confirm it is the *right* one.

Step 2 — PERMISSIONS

Three rows, each with its own button. Each turns into a green tick when granted.

Row	Button	Why it is needed
Bank SMS	Grant	Reads incoming credit SMS.
Notification access	Enable	Reads bank / UPI-app alerts. Turn Katana Agent on in the system list.
Background activity	Allow	Set to Unrestricted so Android does not kill the app.

Step 3 — PAYMENT APPS

Turn on the **one** app you receive money on. Only one can be on at a time — switching one on switches the others off, and the app confirms with "Capturing <app> only".

If you turn everything off, capture pauses and the app says so. Pick the app that actually receives the money — a Paytm/PhonePe mix-up means nothing is ever captured.

Step 4 — RRN CAPTURE

Row	Set to	Why
Screen reader (Accessibility)	Enable → turn Katana Agent on	This is the capture engine. Without it no RRN can ever be read.
Display over other apps	Allow	Needed to read the copied RRN off the clipboard.
Auto-capture	On (default)	New payments are found and read automatically — nothing to tap.
Keep screen awake	On (default)	Stops the screen sleeping. Only works while the phone is plugged in .

Re-check the screen reader after every app update. Some phones (OnePlus / OxygenOS, Oppo / ColorOS) silently switch Accessibility off when the app version changes — leaving the phone in the one state where no RRN can be read. The home screen now calls this out as **SCREEN READER OFF**. After updating, open the app and confirm it says **CAPTURING**.

4. Reading the home screen

The big line at the top says what the phone is *actually doing* — not merely that the app is installed. Only one of these means money is being captured.

Top line	What it means / what to do
CAPTURING	Working. Leave the payment app open on screen.
SETUP NEEDED	Grant the permissions in §3.
NO MERCHANT CODE	Enter the code under CONNECTION and Save.
MERCHANT CODE NOT RECOGNISED	The server does not know that code. Fix it under CONNECTION.
MERCHANT CODE UNVERIFIED	Tap Save settings under CONNECTION to verify it.
NO PAYMENT APP SELECTED	Turn on the app you receive money on.
SCREEN READER OFF	Usually caused by an update. Re-enable it under RRN CAPTURE.
AUTO-CAPTURE IS OFF	Turn Auto-capture back on.

The number, and the four tiles

The large number is **payments captured today on this phone**, with the time of the last one under it. A count that goes up is the only real proof capture is working. Below it:

Tile	Shows
COLLECTING FOR	Which shop this phone credits — the verified merchant name.
READING	Which payment app is being read.
POWER	Plugged in or On battery . On battery the screen sleeps and capture stops with it.
QUEUE	Clear , or how many captures are waiting to upload. A number here means the internet dropped — they send themselves when it returns.

5. Daily use

- Keep the phone **on and plugged in**.
- Leave the **payment app open on screen** — the **Open payment app** button on the home screen takes you straight there.
- That is all. New payments are found, opened, read, and sent automatically.

Leaving the Katana Agent screen showing captures nothing. The engine reads the *payment app*, so while you are looking at the agent, nothing is being read — every indicator stays green. A phone once idled an hour this way. Park it on the payment app.

6. Your payment app — what each one does

App	How the reference is captured
Paytm for Business	The RRN is masked on the payment detail screen; the agent opens each payment and taps Copy to read it.
Airtel Merchant	Full RRN read straight off the reports list.
Google Pay Business	Full RRN read off the payment detail screen.
PhonePe Business	UTR read straight off the History list — nothing is opened. Pull the list down to refresh ; it is a snapshot until you do.
BharatPe	Captured from the payment email — this phone does nothing. See §7.

7. Email channel (BharatPe and emailed receipts)

Under **EMAIL CHANNEL (OPTIONAL)**, connect the Gmail that receives payment emails. **For BharatPe this is the only step** — the email carries the whole payment, so no screen reading is involved and the phone does not need to sit on the payment app.

1. Set and save your **merchant code** first (§3) — the connect button needs it.
2. Tap **Connect Google**. Sign in, tap **Allow**, then come back to the app. The status reads **✓ Connected**.
3. Alternatively, enter the Gmail address and a **16-character app password** and tap save (needs IMAP on).

8. Filling one payment on demand ("Get RRN")

On the dashboard, a payment still missing its reference has a **Get RRN** button. Press it and this phone — as long as it is on, connected, and the payment app is open — re-reads the list and fills that one in. The button clears itself once the reference lands. **Nothing to do on the phone.**

9. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Fix
Top line is not CAPTURING	It names the reason and what to do — work through §4.
Everything looks green but nothing is captured	The phone is almost certainly parked on the agent screen, or on the wrong app. Leave the payment app open.
Stopped right after an update	The screen reader was switched off by the phone. Re-enable it (§3, step 4).
Count stopped going up overnight	Check POWER . On battery the screen sleeps and capture stops — plug it in.
QUEUE shows a number	No internet. Captures are held safely and upload themselves when it returns.
Merchant shows ✗ not recognized	Re-enter the exact code (watch for stray spaces) and Save settings .
PhonePe: recent payments missing	Pull the History list down to refresh it.
Stops after a while	Grant Background activity (Unrestricted) so Android does not kill the app, and keep it charging.

Under the tiles, the **details** block shows merchant, device, endpoint and app version — read those out when you report a problem to your Katana admin.

10. Limits worth knowing

- **The payment app must be open on screen** for RRN capture. This is how Android accessibility works, and it is why a dedicated always-on phone is recommended. (BharatPe over email is the exception — §7.)
- Only payments **visible on the list** can be read. Recent ones are captured automatically; a much older payment needs the list scrolled back to it — ask your Katana admin to run a deep sweep.
- **One phone collects for one merchant code**. Two shops need two phones, or the payments land on the wrong account.
- OTP, PIN and password messages are **never** forwarded.
- The payment itself (amount, payer, time) reaches the dashboard on its own — the agent only adds the **reference**.